Freelance contracts, research interviews, and AI training

Researched 2026-11-12.

Strengths and best use

The reel compares three ways to look for paid project work. Braintrust is most useful when you already have a portfolio for a defined skill. Respondent matches a specific profile to a research study. Outlier and Mercor offer a route for evaluating AI in a subject you can demonstrate.

Current checks

Braintrust advertises zero talent platform fees and ties payment to the client invoice. Payment processors and banks can still charge fees. Respondent normally pays 7-10 business days after attendance confirmation, through Tremendous, and deducts 5% with a $1 minimum. Use the terms of each Outlier or Mercor project to check rates and onboarding. The reel's quoted rates, acceptance odds and time to first assignment lack comparable platform-wide evidence.

Sources checked

Braintrust for talent (https://www.usebraintrust.com/for-talent) - Braintrust payment help (https://support.usebraintrust.com/hc/en-us/articles/14173947347095-When-do-I-get-paid) - Respondent payment help (https://help.respondent.io/en/articles/12552519-getting-paid-on-respondent-timeline-currencies-how-to-redeem) - Respondent participant portal (https://www.respondent.io/become-a-participant) - Outlier contributor FAQ (https://outlier.ai/faq) - Mercor experts (https://www.mercor.com/experts/)

Project idea

Run a two-week trial with one suitable platform. Log unpaid screening, paid work, waiting time, fees and cash received. Calculate net received divided by active time and report the number of available assignments separately. This keeps a good advertised rate from hiding a thin queue.

Reusable prompt

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Design a trial for two platforms using my real skill profile. Record qualification steps, listed payment, fees and payment dates. Leave rates blank when the offer does not specify them.
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Original sources

- https://www.instagram.com/reel/DaCzEyQJaCV/